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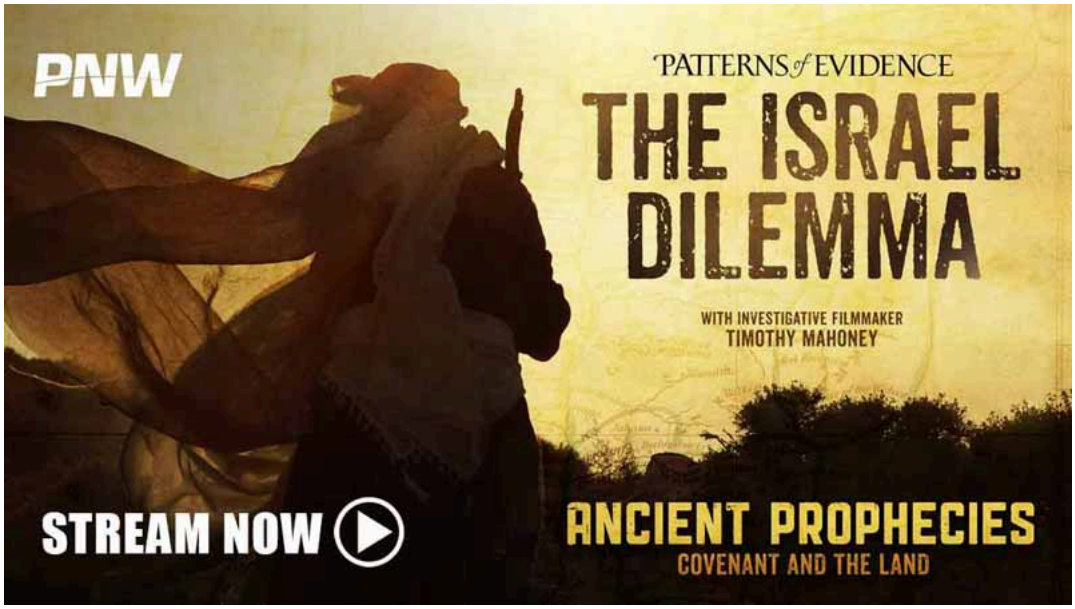

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ARTICLE

When Christians Look Up: Victor Glover, NASA And The Glory Of God In Space

BY PNW STAFF APRIL 04, 2026

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A man climbs on top of a rocket, straps himself into a machine packed with explosive force, rises beyond the atmosphere, looks down on the blue curve of Earth, and says something many in our "enlightened" age would rather laugh away than seriously consider: "There aren't any atheists on top of rockets." For Victor Glover, that was not a throwaway line. It was a confession of reality. And in a culture that often treats faith as childish and science as its replacement, his words landed with unusual force.

They matter even more now because Glover is not speaking from the sidelines. He is the pilot of NASA's Artemis II mission, the first crewed Artemis flight and the first mission to send astronauts around the moon in more than 50 years. NASA says the approximately 10-day mission launched on April 1 and has now departed Earth orbit on its way around the moon, with Glover serving as pilot aboard Orion. He is also making history as part of the first crewed lunar mission of the Artemis era.

That alone would make him notable. But what makes his story powerful for Christians is not simply that he is brilliant enough to fly a spacecraft or courageous enough to trust his life to one. It is that he has refused to accept the false choice our culture keeps trying to force on believers: either trust God or trust science.

From R500 to R350,000

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Glover has said plainly that he believes in both faith and science, and that he does not find them to be in conflict. He has also spoken openly about praying before risky work, saying that his career, military service, and faith are deeply "interwoven." That is not intellectual weakness. That is wholeness.

And frankly, Christian

For too long, many be Bible studies, and private devotionals -- but not in laboratories, engineering bays, flight simulators, operating rooms, boardrooms, or mission control. We have allowed a secular myth to take root: that the closer one gets to knowledge, the further one must move from God.

Victor Glover's life stands as a living rebuke to that lie.

He is not a man who worships ignorance. He is not suspicious of discovery. He is not hiding from the complexity of the universe. He has spent his life learning how things work -- how aircraft move, how systems respond, how the laws of physics behave under pressure. And after all that study, all that training, all that exposure to the astonishing order of creation, he has not concluded that God is unnecessary. He has concluded the opposite.

That should stir something in us.

Because the Christian faith has never truly been anti-science. It has been anti-idolatry. And those are not the same thing.

Science is a tool. A remarkable one. It can measure motion, map galaxies, analyze DNA, and reveal breathtaking patterns in the natural world. But science cannot tell you why beauty moves you. It cannot explain why moral truth presses on the conscience. It cannot answer why the human heart aches for meaning, eternity, forgiveness, and glory. It can tell you what stars are made of. It cannot tell you why the heavens feel like they are preaching.

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Scripture can.

"The heavens declare the glory of God, and the sky above proclaims his handiwork."

That is not anti-scientific poetry. That is the deepest possible interpretation of reality.

And when Glover talks about seeing the beauty of creation while working in space, he is touching something Christians have always known: that the created world does not merely exist -- it testifies. He has noted that at NASA, when he refers to the "beauty of creation," people

react to that word. Of is accidental. But perhaps that is precis

Not obnoxiously. Not superficially. But boldly.

Because if the universe is truly God's handiwork, then every field of honest study becomes, in some sense, a place of worship. Astronomy can become awe. Biology can become wonder. Engineering can become stewardship. Medicine can become mercy. Teaching can become service. Parenting can become discipleship. Business can become integrity. Art can become praise.

That may be one of the most encouraging parts of Glover's witness. Before one of his earlier space missions, he said he wanted to use the abilities God had given him to do his job well and support his crewmates and mission. That is such a simple sentence, but it carries enormous spiritual weight.

Because many Christians are still waiting for permission to be "used by God" in some dramatic, visibly religious way, while quietly overlooking the gifts already sitting in their hands.

What if your calling is not behind a pulpit?

What if your faithfulness looks like doing excellent work in a place where almost no one expects to see Christ honored?

What if your mission field is a school, a hospital, a newsroom, a police car, a software company, a courtroom, a construction site, or yes -- even a spacecraft?

The point is not that every Christian must become famous or extraordinary in the eyes of the world. Victor Glover's story is not inspiring because he became an astronaut. It is inspiring because he appears to understand something many believers forget: your gifts are not random, and your work is not spiritually neutral.

If God has given you a sharp mind, use it for His glory.
If He has given you leadership, lead with holiness.
If He has given you creativity, build things that reflect truth and beauty.
If He has given you endurance, spend it in service.
If He has given you influence, do not waste it on yourself.

That is the deeper challenge hidden inside Glover's testimony.

His words about rockets are memorable, but the more searching question is this: What do you do with your life when you realize you are living under the gaze of God?

Some people only ask eternal questions when danger is immediate -- in foxholes, hospital rooms, funerals, crashes, diagnoses, and moments of terror. And yes, crisis has a way of stripping away illusion. But mature faith does not wait for catastrophe to become reverent. It learns to see God in the ordinary, the gifted, the disciplined, and the beautiful.

Victor Glover looked at the universe and saw not emptiness, but majesty.

May more Christians do the same.

And may his witness remind the church of something we desperately need to recover: you do not have to choose between a serious mind and a serious faith. You do not have to apologize for believing that science can reveal mechanism while Scripture reveals meaning. And you

do not have to shrink

God is Lord of the sar

And if He can be honored on top of a rocket, He can certainly be honored through your life.

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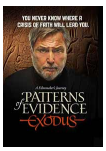

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